Desktop publishing (DTP) terms & techniques

GRAPHICS WITH MR KELLY

National 5 · Design & DTP · Worksheet

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

By the end of this worksheet I can…

- ☐ explain the role of thumbnails and annotation
- ☐ identify DTP features in a layout: text wrap, reverse, drop shadow, bleed, flow text along a path, columns, gutter
- ☐ explain why a serif or sans serif font suits a layout

I DO — Worked example

Read how a full-mark answer is built

A designer produces several small, quick layout sketches before using DTP software.

1 Explain two benefits of thumbnails. (2 marks)

Full-mark answer each ✓ is one mark

Thumbnails are a quick way to try out a range of layout ideas before committing to one ✓. They can be shown to the client for feedback early, saving time on the final DTP layout ✓.

Why answers lose marks

"They are small and easy."

0 marks: no benefit is explained.

WE DO — Guided practice

Use the starters and word bank to help you

A sportswear poster uses a sans serif font.

2 Explain why a sans serif font suits the poster. (1 mark)

Sentence starters

One reason is … because …

Another reason is … so …

Word bank

matching · target · audience · sporty · distance · appeals · modern

Tip: 1 marks = 1 separate, developed points.

YOU DO **On your own** No notes. Check your answers afterwards.

3 Quick check: tick one box for each.

a) The space between two columns is the…
☐ Margin ☐ Gutter ☐ Bleed ☐ Header

b) White text on a black box is…
☐ Reverse ☐ Transparency ☐ Drop shadow ☐ Bleed

c) Why does a designer extend the background past the trim edge?
☐ To use more ink ☐ So no white edge shows after cutting (bleed) ☐ For registration ☐ To add a margin

d) A sans serif font suits a modern layout because…
☐ It is formal and traditional ☐ It looks clean and modern and is easy to read ☐ It looks handwritten ☐ It is always bold

4 Key terms: write the letter of the matching description next to each term.

1. **Thumbnail**	____	**A** Text flowing around an image.
2. **Gutter**	____	**B** Text following a curved line.
3. **Bleed**	____	**C** Background extending past the trim edge so no white edge shows.
4. **Reverse**	____	**D** Light text on a dark background.
5. **Text wrap**	____	**E** Small, quick layout sketch for generating ideas.
6. **Flow text along a path**	____	**F** The gap between columns.

5 Explain the relationship between A4 and A3 paper sizes. (1 mark)

A leaflet has white text inside a dark circle, body text flowing around a curved image and a shadow under each photo.

6 State the DTP technique used for each. (3 marks)

A promotional layout is being designed in DTP software.

7 Describe four features of the layout that DTP software helped to create. Refer to the layout. (4 marks)

Check and reflect

Mark your answers with the answer sheet. Go back to the checklist on the site and re-rate each “I can” statement above. Which one still needs work?